

D841

Secondary English Language Arts Curriculum

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A speech about water safety, delivered at a well-attended town meeting, says: As a lifeguard for twenty years who has pulled over 100 swimmers from the water, I can tell you these rules save lives. The speaker wore a red jacket. Which appeal is the speaker mainly using?

- A. Logos, because it includes a number.
- B. Visual appeal from the red jacket.
- C. Ethos.
- D. Pathos.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which sentence relies mainly on logos?

- A. Everyone knows safety is always the only thing that matters.
- B. Towns that installed lifeguard stations saw drownings drop by half, so our town should install them.
- C. Imagine the heartbreak of a family losing a child.
- D. As a doctor, I urge you to act.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

At a school board meeting in a newly built auditorium, one speaker proposes a later start time. Another replies: My opponent wants students to sleep all day and never learn anything. The meeting ran for three hours. Which fallacy is this?

- A. False dilemma.
- B. Straw man.
- C. Ad hominem.
- D. Appeal to authority, because it was a board meeting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A speaker says: Either we ban phones in school completely, or students will never learn anything. Which fallacy is this?

- A.** False dilemma.
- B.** It is not a fallacy.
- C.** Ad hominem.
- D.** Straw man.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

In a novel with a beautiful cover, a ship captain shouts, All hands on deck! The novel was translated into twelve languages. What figure of speech is all hands?

- A.** Metaphor.
- B.** Hyperbole, because it was translated so widely.
- C.** Synecdoche.
- D.** Metonymy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

In a story told in first person, the narrator insists he is calm and reasonable, while describing sleepless nights, racing thoughts, and violent plans. The story was first published in a monthly magazine. What should students conclude about the narrator?

- A.** He is reliable because the story was published.
- B.** He is an unreliable narrator; his actions contradict his claims.
- C.** He is reliable because first-person narrators tell the truth.
- D.** The story uses third-person omniscient point of view.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

In a novel set in a small South American town, a grandmother floats to the ceiling while folding laundry, and the family simply continues dinner. The author won a major prize. What movement does this passage reflect?

- A. Magical realism.
- B. Fantasy.
- C. Realism.
- D. Romanticism.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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8.

A teacher who performs in a community theater shows students this line: But soft, what light through yonder window breaks. The line has ten syllables in an unstressed-stressed pattern. The play is often staged outdoors. What is the meter?

- A. Free verse, because it is staged outdoors.
- B. Trochaic pentameter.
- C. Iambic decameter, since there are ten syllables.
- D. Iambic pentameter.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A line has eight syllables in an unstressed-stressed pattern. What is the meter?

- A. Iambic pentameter.
- B. Trochaic tetrameter.
- C. Iambic tetrameter.
- D. Iambic octameter.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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10.

A teacher who keeps a jar of pencils on every table asks students to classify this sentence: Although the storm was strong, the team finished the game, and the fans stayed. The sentence comes from a sports article. What type of sentence is it?

- A. Compound-complex.
- B. Simple, because it is about sports.
- C. Complex.
- D. Compound.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which sentence is complex?

- A. The bus was late, and we missed the first class.
- B. The bus was late.
- C. Because the bus was late, we missed class, and the teacher marked us tardy.
- D. Because the bus was late, we missed the first class.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A department chair with a popular teaching blog must choose a resource for the standard: analyze how an author uses rhetoric to advance a purpose. The budget is \$2,000. Which resource fits best?

- A. A popular novel series students love.
- B. A grammar workbook.
- C. The most expensive resource under \$2,000.
- D. A collection of speeches and essays with tasks asking how rhetorical choices serve the author's purpose.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A speech about water safety, ~~delivered at a well-attended town meeting,~~ says: As a lifeguard for twenty years who has pulled over 100 swimmers from the water, I can tell you these rules save lives. ~~The speaker wore a red jacket.~~ Which appeal is the speaker mainly using?

Target word: identify appeal **Decides:** The speaker cites personal experience and credentials.

A	Confusion set	The number serves credibility, not a logical argument.
B	Camouflage	Clothing is irrelevant.
C	Correct	Establishes the speaker's credibility.
D	Adjacent category	The main move is credibility, not emotion.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

Which sentence relies mainly on logos?

Target word: produce the logic appeal **Decides:** Reasoning from evidence.

A	Absolute language	An unsupported absolute, not logical evidence.
B	Correct	Evidence plus a reasoned conclusion.
C	Confusion set	Pathos.
D	Adjacent category	Ethos.

3. Answer B Concept 2

At a school board meeting ~~in a newly built auditorium,~~ one speaker proposes a later start time. Another replies: My opponent wants students to sleep all day and never learn anything. ~~The meeting ran for three hours.~~ Which fallacy is this?

Target word: identify fallacy **Decides:** The reply distorts the proposal into an extreme version.

A	Adjacent category	No two-choice framing is given.
B	Correct	Misrepresents the argument to attack it.
C	Confusion set	That would attack the speaker personally.
D	Camouflage	The setting does not create the fallacy.

4. Answer A Concept 2 • transfer

A speaker says: Either we ban phones in school completely, or students will never learn anything. Which fallacy is this?

Target word: identify a different fallacy **Decides:** Only two extreme options are offered.

A	Correct	Presents only two choices when others exist.
B	Inverted operation	Ignoring middle options is fallacious.
C	Adjacent category	No personal attack.
D	Confusion set	No opponent's argument is distorted.

5. Answer C Concept 3

In a novel ~~with a beautiful cover~~, a ship captain shouts, All hands on deck! ~~The novel was translated into twelve languages.~~ What figure of speech is all hands?

Target word: identify the figure **Decides:** A part (hands) stands for the whole (sailors).

A	Adjacent category	Nothing is compared.
B	Camouflage	Translations do not decide the figure.
C	Correct	A part represents the whole person.
D	Confusion set	Metonymy uses a related thing, not a part.

6. Answer B Concept 4

In a story told in first person, the narrator insists he is calm and reasonable, while describing sleepless nights, racing thoughts, and violent plans. ~~The story was first published in a monthly magazine.~~ What should students conclude about the narrator?

Target word: judge reliability **Decides:** Claims conflict with described behavior.

A	Camouflage	Publication is irrelevant.
B	Correct	Contradictions signal unreliability.
C	Absolute language	First person does not guarantee reliability.
D	Confusion set	It is first person.

7. Answer A Concept 5

In a novel set in a small South American town, a grandmother floats to the ceiling while folding laundry, and the family simply continues dinner. ~~The author won a major prize.~~ What movement does this passage reflect?

Target word: identify movement **Decides:** The supernatural is treated as ordinary in a realistic setting.

A	Correct	Supernatural events accepted as everyday.
B	Confusion set	Fantasy builds an invented world where magic is marked as magic.
C	Dropped element	Drops the supernatural element.
D	Adjacent category	Focuses on emotion and nature.

8. Answer D Concept 6

A teacher ~~who performs in a community theater~~ shows students this line: But soft, what light through yonder window breaks. The line has ten syllables in an unstressed-stressed pattern. ~~The play is often staged outdoors.~~ What is the meter?

Target word: name meter **Decides:** Ten syllables in unstressed-stressed pairs = five iambs.

A	Camouflage	The staging does not decide meter.
B	Inverted operation	Trochees are stressed-unstressed.
C	Confusion set	Counts syllables as feet.
D	Correct	Five iambic feet.

9. Answer C Concept 6 • transfer

A line has eight syllables in an unstressed-stressed pattern. What is the meter?

Target word: solve for number of feet **Decides:** 8 syllables / 2 per iamb = 4 feet.

A	Wrong stem number	Pentameter needs ten syllables.
B	Inverted operation	Reverses the stress pattern.
C	Correct	Four iambs.
D	Confusion set	Counts syllables as feet.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A teacher ~~who keeps a jar of pencils on every table~~ asks students to classify this sentence: Although the storm was strong, the team finished the game, and the fans stayed. ~~The sentence comes from a sports article.~~ What type of sentence is it?

Target word: classify sentence **Decides:** One dependent clause and two independent clauses.

A	Correct	Two independent clauses plus a dependent clause.
B	Camouflage	Topic does not decide structure.
C	Dropped element	Drops the second independent clause.
D	Dropped element	Drops the dependent clause.

11. Answer D Concept 7 • transfer

Which sentence is complex?

Target word: produce a complex sentence **Decides:** One independent plus one dependent clause.

A	Confusion set	Compound: two independent clauses.
B	Dropped element	Simple.
C	Adjacent category	Compound-complex.
D	Correct	Dependent clause plus independent clause.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A department chair ~~with a popular teaching blog~~ must choose a resource for the standard: analyze how an author uses rhetoric to advance a purpose. ~~The budget is \$2,000.~~ Which resource fits best?

Target word: aligned resource **Decides:** Must let students analyze rhetoric for purpose.

A	Adjacent category	Engaging but not focused on rhetoric.
B	Confusion set	Targets conventions, not rhetoric.
C	Camouflage	Price does not show alignment.
D	Correct	Directly practices the standard.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	3	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	11	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Rhetorical appeals	Ethos appeals to the speaker's credibility, pathos to the audience's emotions, and logos to logic and evidence.	Labeling any statistic as ethos or any story as logos.	What the passage relies on to persuade.
2	Logical fallacies	Ad hominem attacks the person; straw man distorts the argument; false dilemma offers only two choices; slippery slope predicts an unsupported chain of events.	Mixing up straw man and ad hominem.	An argument that responds to something other than the actual claim.
3	Figurative language	Metaphor compares without like or as; synecdoche uses a part for the whole; metonymy uses a closely related thing to stand for something.	Calling every figure of speech a metaphor.	A word stands in for something else.
4	Point of view and reliability	Point of view (first person, third limited, third omniscient) controls what the reader knows; an unreliable narrator's account conflicts with evidence in the text.	Assuming a first-person narrator is always truthful.	Contradictions between a narrator's claims and events.
5	Literary movements	Movements have signature features: Romanticism values emotion and nature; Realism depicts ordinary life; Modernism fragments form; magical realism blends the supernatural into an everyday setting as ordinary.	Confusing magical realism with fantasy.	Traits of a passage point to a movement.
6	Meter	A foot is a unit of stressed and unstressed syllables; iambic pentameter has five iambs (unstressed-stressed), usually ten syllables per line.	Counting syllables as feet.	A line's syllable count and stress pattern.
7	Sentence types	Simple: one independent clause; compound: two or more independent clauses; complex: one independent plus a dependent clause; compound-complex: two or more independent plus at least one dependent.	Calling any long sentence compound.	Subordinating words like because or although.
8	Standards-aligned resource selection	Choose and adapt curricular resources by whether they let students practice and show the targeted standard, with appropriate complexity and relevance.	Choosing resources for popularity, length, or appearance.	A choice among resources for a named standard.

Course scope (public description): Secondary English Language Arts Curriculum explores the integration of literary analysis, language development, and curriculum design to prepare candidates for teaching in secondary ELA classrooms and for the Praxis 5039 English Language Arts exam. This course guides candidates through a comprehensive study of global literature, rhetorical techniques, language strategies, and assessment methodologies, thereby enabling them to effectively align their teaching practices with state content standards and student needs. Emphasizing critical evaluation and application, the course equips educators with the tools to research, select, and adapt ELA curricular resources to diverse educational settings. There are no prerequisites for this course.